The Noble One Hundred and Eight Names of Kṣitigarbha, Together with the Dhāraṇī-Mantra

Ārya Kṣitigarbhāṣṭottaraśatakanāma Dhāraṇīmantrasahita · Toh 881 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་སའི་སྙིང་པོའི་མཚན་བར་རྒྱ་རྩ་རྒྱད་པ་གཟུངས་སྔགས་དང་བཅས་པ།

The Noble One Hundred and Eight Names of Kṣitigarbha, Together with the Dhāraṇī-Mantra, known in Tibetan as Phagpa Sai Nyingpoi Tsen Gya Tsa Gyepa Zung Ngak Dang Chepa, is a short devotional and incantatory work centered on the bodhisattva Kṣitigarbha, whose name in Sanskrit means "Earth Womb" or "Earth Matrix." It opens with homage to Kṣitigarbha as great king of the maṇḍala and gives his dhāraṇī. In verse, the recitation causes the vajra maṇḍala and Mount Kailāsa to shake, and Vajrapāṇi then praises Kṣitigarbha for a mantra that averts the suffering and faults of beings, so that those who hear it remain unstained by saṃsāra, like lotuses rising from the mud. The text belongs to the genre of litanies of one hundred and eight names joined with protective and meritorious mantras. It is Toh 881 in the Kangyur, where it is found among the dhāraṇī texts.

The Noble One Hundred and Eight Names of Kṣitigarbha, Together with the Dhāraṇī-Mantra

Homage to the bodhisattva, the great being Kṣitigarbha, great king of the maṇḍala.

oṃ sumbhani sumbha hara cara mahābāśa marutā amoghavajrasatva svāhā

Then, as soon as this dhāraṇī
That bestows good qualities had been spoken,
The sublime vajra maṇḍala
Shook, together with snowy Mount Kailāsa.
To Kṣitigarbha, lord of the assembly,
The Blessed One, the Vajra Holder (Vajrapāṇi), spoke:
"Excellent, excellent, greatly fortunate one!
You have made the face of the earth vast.
Your dhāraṇī is widely renowned,
And brings forth immeasurable supreme qualities.
Those who hear what averts
The suffering and faults of all beings,
Even as they wander through saṃsāra,
Are not stained by any fault,

Just as lotuses in the mud
Are not stained by the faults of the mud.
Whoever among embodied beings
Holds your secret mantra,
Not even a single one of them
Will turn back from awakening.
Whatever wise person, having heard
The supreme dhāraṇī-mantra, takes it to heart with faith
Will certainly attain
All good qualities; of this there is no doubt."

Then the entire assembly
Rose, and to the lord of the earth,
Kṣitigarbha, supreme on the earth,
Spoke these one hundred and eight names:

Kṣitigarbha, great chief,
Whose eyes are like flashing lightning,
Crowned one, who has attained the ground,
Perfectly endowed, supreme in riches,
Possessed of knowledge, maker of knowledge, worthy of offerings,
Chief, ascetic, teacher,
Having the way of the wind, possessed of a foundation,
Wise in svāhā, supreme in compassion,
Supreme sun of omniscience,
Renowned as knower of the essence of essences,
Sporting in secret mantra, sporting vastly,
Lord of the earth, possessed of the arts of dance,
Graceful one, fair of face, endowed as a dancer,
Teacher who shows the fruit directly,
Subhūti, knower of the essence of intelligence,
Who has attained the essence, fearless,
Protector possessed of a buddha's form,
Who through wisdom sees everything without exception,
Dispeller of faults such as attachment,
Teacher of the great art of dance,
Teacher like a wish-fulfilling tree,
Lord of space, of melodious speech,

He is the great sun itself,
Maheśvara (Śiva), encircled by blazing light,
Enjoyer of infinite qualities,
Lord of the earth, possessed of a field of activity,
Great enjoyer of the enjoyment of the Dharma,
A great lake brimming as an ocean of qualities,
Enjoyer of manifold qualities,
Supreme of the Tathāgata family,
Skilled in the profound ways of method,
The Great Vehicle, fearless,
Great offering, great sound,
Possessed of a maṇḍala renowned like the moon,
Great Vajradhara of a hundred names,
Vajra maṇḍala, crowned with flowers,
Great intelligence, long-armed,
Great lotus, of great strength,
Great secret mantra, great assembly,
Great earth, Mount Meru,
Vajrapāṇi, through those qualities
Adorned with a crown of jewel flowers,
Enjoyer of the expanse of equality,
Possessed of an ocean of vast fields,
Possessed of vajra light, endowed with the vajra,
Lord of the earth like Mount Meru,
Enjoyer of the earth, of excellent enjoyments,
Perfect in wielding weapons,
Renowned as a vessel of vast expanse,
Skilled in speech, vajra that utterly crushes,
Whose eyes are faintly red,
Bound with a crown of blue flowers,
Of great zeal, long-armed,
Steadfast, firm, and giver of bliss,
Caravan leader, great glorious and excellent one,
Like the snowy Mount Meru,
Indra, great king Yama,
Mighty Viṣṇu, lord of strength,
Supreme family of the world, buddha, Brahmā,

Whose field of activity is the way of suchness,
Jewel crest, broadly smiling,
Delighted, wearing garments of many kinds,
Far-seeing, wide-eyed,
Unobstructed like space,
Unimpeded, immeasurable, jewel crown,
Cause of freedom from desire for the three realms of existence,
Tamed one, who clears away the stains of affliction,
Pure, clean, keeper of the poṣadha,
Victorious, gone beyond battle,
Green in color, giver of refuge, of great compassion,
Of vast renown through strength,
Whose field of activity is knowledge when contemplated,
Hero, lion, terrifier,
Crusher of the hearts of the hostile,
Sovereign, renowned, possessed of domains,
From whom vast joy arises,
Knower of families, knower of the essence of families,
Worshipped in all families,
King, support that brings forth the supreme family,
Adorned with the vajra maṇḍala,
Vajra renowned beneath the earth,
Holder of vidyā-mantras, of great strength,
Exalted one, supreme pervader,
Fine-throated, free of illness,
Protector, pure teacher,
Who fully reveals the path of the buddhas,
Liberated one, ripener, who brings others to bow down,
Adorned with all the maṇḍalas without exception,
Fully entered, skilled in the maṇḍalas,
Vajra master, support of good qualities,
Giver of accomplishments, supremely pure,
Who understands what is proper and what is improper,

Possessor of a maṇḍala veined with yellow,
Endowed with the radiance of green light rays,
Yellow, and clad in yellow robes,

Adorned with every maṇḍala without exception,
With red-veined eyes, splendor of the moon,
Source of the light of many kinds of jewels,
Emanating through the power of a hundred vajras,
Equal in equality, stainless,
Pure in body and pure in robe,
Knowing purity and endowed with purity,
Possessor of the pure Dharma, a radiance,
Who dispels the craving of beings,
Wise one who brings saṃsāra to an end,
Knower of the way, whose domain is right conduct,
Essence of the vajra ocean,
Vajrasattva, great in virtue,
Wise one, vast as the multitude of beings,
Excellent light renowned everywhere,
Kṣitigarbha, great essence,
Vajra essence, guide,
Immeasurable, perfect in the immeasurable,
Dwelling in the most exalted domain,
Lord, profound and clear,
Cool light of the moon's disc,
Who brings forth joy and faith,
Whose domain is vast wisdom,
Fierce like the violence of the wind,
Being fierce, pure dispeller of the fierce,
Bringer of victory, peaceful victor,
Who brings glory to the victors and brings them joy,
Surpassing Mount Meru, Mount Kailāsa, and Malaya
In the profundity of his domain,
Great essence of jewel and vajra,
Lord of the domain of the earth,
Light arising from a jewel rock,
Adorned with vajra maṇḍalas,
Who delights in devotion to the tathāgatas,
Mighty foundation of glory,
Radiant, maker of glory, pure,
Lord of the ten directions, great lord.

Thus, when Vajrasattva had praised
The great Vajradhara with these supreme hundred and eight names,
The vajra, supreme lord of the three worlds, spoke:
"Those who know the essence of good qualities
Recite the supreme hundred and eight names;
Other than this, which averts faults,
I have seen nothing on earth.
These sacred hundred and eight names
Are a joy that accomplishes everything;
They dispel all evil deeds,
Are free of every stain, and are certain in their good qualities.
Therefore, with all diligence,
People who wish for excellence
Should recite these virtuous hundred and eight names
Always and again.
These sacred hundred and eight names
Are the supreme, unsurpassed abode
Of all wishes and of wealth;
They bestow vast glory.
Whoever, with a mind most clear,
Recites the illustrious names of Kṣitigarbha,
Supreme qualities that fully accomplish all desires,
And these sacred hundred and eight names
That hold vast glory,
Whatever person recites them
Will swiftly be freed from all suffering."

The Noble Hundred and Eight Names of Kṣitigarbha, Together with the Dhāraṇī-Mantra, is complete.

Translator's Notes

• Within the list of epithets, the word rendered "Subhūti" (following the house glossary) may here simply be an epithet meaning "of excellent prosperity" rather than an allusion to the disciple Subhūti. "The Vajra Holder" (rdo rje can) is taken as Vajrapāṇi, who is named later in the list. Several epithets (for example "having the way of the wind, possessed of a foundation") are terse and their exact sense is uncertain. "Maheśvara" in the list is taken as one of the epithets applied to Kṣitigarbha, like Indra, Yama, Viṣṇu and Brahmā later in the list; it could also be read generically as "great lord".
• The opening line, literally "possessing a maṇḍala with yellow veins/lines," is obscure. It may describe a yellow-hued disc or aura.

The speaker who says "I have seen nothing on earth" is "the vajra, supreme lord of the three worlds." This may refer to Vajradhara answering Vajrasattva's praise, but the Tibetan does not name him explicitly.

The lines on Meru, Kailāsa, and Malaya read the particle "yas" as comparative ("more than") with "non pa," "to overpower or surpass." An alternative reading is "overpowering the profound domain, like Meru, Kailāsa, and Malaya."

"Three worlds" renders sa gsum, the three levels of the world (below, upon, and above the earth). It is distinct from the three realms (khams gsum).

The Tibetan has "mi brgya rtsa brgyad" in one line, evidently a scribal slip for "ming brgya rtsa brgyad," "hundred and eight names."

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.